

ALEX RAYTSELSKY

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Principal / Senior Data Center Network Architect and engineering leader with over 20 years of experience designing, implementing, and optimizing enterprise LAN, WAN, cloud, and virtualization infrastructure. Proven track record in orchestrating complex SD-WAN platforms, EVPN/VXLAN data center fabrics, and multi-cloud interconnects. Expert in streamlining network operations, accelerating deployment cycles, and improving reliability through Python, REST API, Ansible, and Infrastructure as Code (IaC) automation. Specialized in real-time anomaly detection and root-cause analysis across VXLAN EVPN fabrics.

CORE EXPERTISE

DATA CENTER & WAN ARCHITECTURE Cisco Nexus (5k/6k/7k/9k), Arista, Meraki LAN/WAN, Aruba EdgeConnect SD-WAN, Fabric Design	FABRIC & ROUTING PROTOCOLS ACI, EVPN/VXLAN, Multi-Site Domain (MSD), BGP, OSPF, IS-IS, EIGRP, STP, VLAN/VRF
NETWORK AUTOMATION & APIS Python, REST APIs, Ansible, Terraform, Bash, PowerShell, Selenium, Tcl/Tk, CI/CD Pipelines	CLOUD & VIRTUALIZATION AWS, Azure, Alkira CNaaS, VMware ESXi, KVM, Kubernetes, Docker (4,000+ VM environments)
OPERATIONS & SECURITY IPAM (Infoblox), NetBrain, Splunk, SNMP, SolarWinds, Wireshark, Ixia, Spirent, Firewalls	LEADERSHIP & TELEMETRY MOPs, Architecture Docs, Agile/Scrum, gRPC (GPB encoding), HTTP/UDP (JSON encoding)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Ahead | Sr. Network Engineer Nov 2024 – Present | Remote

- Architect and implement enterprise data center LAN and edge WAN infrastructure, optimizing transport performance and site connectivity across enterprise environments.
- Lead Centralized SD-WAN Orchestration using Aruba EdgeConnect Orchestrator to enforce Business Intent Overlay (BIO) policies, application-aware routing, and dynamic path conditioning.
- Manage Cisco EVPN/VXLAN and Nexus Dashboard/DCNM operations across greenfield and brownfield site discovery, migration, RMA, and decommissioning initiatives.
- Establish Layer 3 connectivity from internal VXLAN fabrics to external networks using Multi-Site Domain (MSD) architectures in multi-tenant Nexus Dashboard environments.
- Provision and scale cloud networking infrastructure on Alkira's Cloud Networking as a Service (CNaaS) platform using Terraform, Ansible, REST APIs, and Python frameworks.
- Direct network maintenance windows, equipment lifecycle upgrades, hardware replacements, and data center decommissionings in coordination with cross-functional ops teams.

Kyndryl (IBM) | Sr. Network Engineer (Data Center) Oct 2020 – Nov 2024 | Remote

- Designed, implemented, and optimized multi-tenant data center LAN, edge WAN, and cloud network architectures focused on high availability, security, and scalability.
- Built a multi-source network intelligence pipeline by integrating NetBrain, Splunk, and Infoblox IPAM via REST APIs to automate enterprise reporting and diagnostics.
- Managed multi-tenant Cisco Nexus Dashboard and Cisco ACI infrastructure, overseeing system configurations, platform upgrades, incident responses, and vendor technical escalations.

- Automated routine network provisioning and operational workflows using Python, REST APIs, and Ansible within Agile/Scrum delivery models.
- Established standard operating procedures, authored comprehensive MOPs, and led troubleshooting for high-priority outages to reduce mean time to resolution (MTTR).

Cisco Systems | Customer Success Engineer**Jun 2013 – Oct 2020 | San Jose, CA**

- Administered large-scale VMware infrastructure supporting 4,000+ virtual machines, 60 virtual switches, and 50+ ESXi hosts.
- Deployed and maintained monitoring and log analytics solutions using Kafka, ZooKeeper, Elasticsearch, and Kibana (EFK stack).
- Monitored complex Cisco Nexus switching environments using SNMP v1/v2/v3, proactively addressing performance alerts and infrastructure anomalies.
- Streamlined operational tasks and VM management (OVA/ISO deployments) across ESXi and KVM environments using Bash, PowerShell, and REST API automation.

Cisco Systems | Technical Lead / Integration Test Engineer**Feb 2002 – Jun 2013 | San Jose, CA**

- Served as Technical Lead for integration, performance, scalability, and stress testing across Cisco Nexus 5000/6000/7000/9000 platform series.
- Developed automated Python, Selenium, and Tcl/Tk test suites to validate Layer 3 scale testbeds across EVPN, FabricPath, and Classical Ethernet modes.
- Validated Layer 2/Layer 3 ASIC programming, packet forwarding, FIB/adjacency tables, ACL TCAM limits, and convergence times using Ixia, Spirent, and packet analysis tools.

EDUCATION**Bachelor of Science in Computer Science**

Polytechnic University, Odessa, Ukraine

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- **CCNP** – Cisco Certified Network Professional
- **CCDA** – Cisco Certified Design Associate
- **ACE** – Aviatix Certified Engineer (Multi-Cloud)
- **CNE** – Certified NetWare Engineer, Novell
- **Docker and Kubernetes: Complete Guide** (Udemy)